



AN INVESTIGATION INTO REFLECTIVE PRACTICES OF J. KRISHNAMURTI'S IDEOLOGY

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ABSTRACT

The main purpose of this study is to investigate reflective practices of J. Krishnamurti's Ideology. Therefore, Researcher has selected Rajghat Besant School, Varanasi, UP, India, for exploring the reflective practices of ideological insight of J. Krishnamurti. It is an empirical enquiry to analyse the ideology of J. Krishnamurti and investigate that this ideology creates a distinctive environment and regulate functions of the institution. For this purpose, researcher has prepared a semi structured interview for the administrator/principal/senior teacher etc. keeping in mind the ideology and institutional or school activities i.e. academics, co-curricular activities, extra-curricular activities, school, and community relationship. Based on these dimensions, researcher has also prepared an institutional profile in the light of J. Krishnamurti's ideology. Researcher has found that Rajghat Besant School effectively exercised ideological insights of J. Krishnamurti in School Practices.

Keywords: *Reflective Practices of J. Krishnamurti's Ideology, Rajghat Besant School (RBS)*

Introduction

J. Krishnamurti's main concern was always education and its pillars. He opposed any type of conditioning like nationality, religion, prejudices, fears, and desires and felt that if only the young and the old could be awakened to their conditioning, it certainly leads to conflict, they might bring to their lives a totally different quality.

He enjoyed with school children and his language was very lucid and simple. Krishnamurti explored the relationship between people and nature with them and psychological problems like fear, authority, competition, love, and freedom. He believes that school is a place in which where students could explore larger existential issues in an atmosphere of freedom and responsibility.

The main features of the Krishnamurti's schools—large campuses with natural beauty; a friendly, healthy relationship between teachers and students, vegetarian and simple diet, comfortable residential facility, spacious and inviting classrooms, libraries and laboratories with all the facilities and small teacher-student ratio. This concern of J. Krishnamurti has found in the form of establishment of schools in India and abroad.

The chief concern of Krishnamurti schools to bring about a radical transformation in human consciousness. These schools are tried to awaken intelligence and sensitivity with academic proficiency in the child in a non-competitive environment.

Krishnamurti was inspired by the University of Berkeley in California, which influenced his decision to set up educational institutions in his own right in 1920. The Rajghat Besant School a co-educational boarding school at Rajghat, was built with a vision of Krishnamurti, to set up a spiritual institution that will transform minds and awaken human consciousness.

Review of Related Literature

There have been a lot of studies conducted in order to analyse the educational philosophy of J. Krishnamurti. Mukerji, J. (2002), Mathur, A. (2007), Pandey, P.S. (2013), Padaliya, P. and Pachauri, S.C. (2017), and Thapan, M. (2019) and many more have attempted to investigate the relevance of educational philosophy of J. Krishnamurti in modern context and other aspects/dimensions. These eminent studies are kind of philosophical studies.

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This study is an empirical investigation in which researcher has attempted to investigate the reflective practices of J. Krishnamurti ideological insights within the educational settings. This study has tried to explore the hidden treasure lies in the ideology devoted deeply to education and institutions built to materialize his dream.

Research Question

1. Does the Ideology of J. Krishnamurti create distinctive atmosphere and regulate functions of Rajghat Besant School (RBS)?

Objective

1. To Analyze the Ideology of J. Krishnamurti.

Operational Definitions of Key Terms

- **Reflective Practices of J. Krishnamurti's Ideology:**

In this research paper, the term Reflective Practices of J. Krishnamurti's Ideology means, the reflections of ideological insights of J. Krishnamurti on the whole educational process i.e. aims of education, means of education, principles of education, purpose of education etc.

- **Rajghat Besant School (RBS):**

This term means, Rajghat Besant School (RBS), Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh, India, which is running under Krishnamurti Foundation, India (KFI).

Method and Approach of Study

The study is exploratory and descriptive in nature. All the information and data were analysed by applying qualitative approach of research.

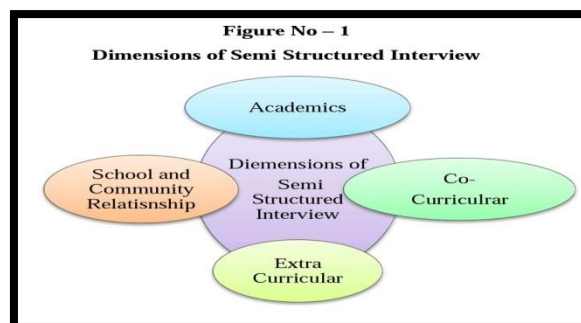
Method of Sampling

Researcher has applied purposive method of sampling for the selection of institution.

Tools

Keeping in mind, the research question and objective of this research, researcher has prepared a semi structured interview. Researcher has also done

a keen non-participatory observation for better understanding of ideological implications of J. Krishnamurti in school practices. The dimensions of semi structured interview have shown in following figure.



Method of Data Collection and Analysis

Researcher has interviewed Administrator/Teacher/Principal of Rajghat Besant School (RBS). Researcher has transcript and analysed all the responses of Administrator/Teacher/Principal dimensionally.

Data Analysis and Interpretation

Researcher has gone through all the responses and analysed thoroughly according to the dimensions and components of the Interview. Researcher has prepared and asked few questions from designates and analysed all the responses. A detailed institutional profile has created by the researcher under the dimension of academics, co-curricular activities, extra-curricular activities and school and community relationship for investigating reflective practices of J. Krishnamurti's ideology.

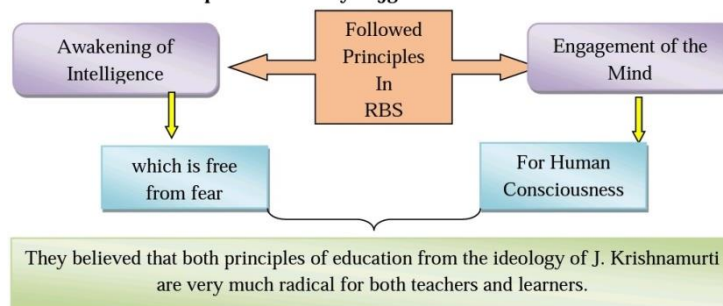
Academics

Academic activities are the lifeline of any institution because they are the reflections of ideology and philosophy of the institution. So that researcher has prepared some items on the basis of components on academic activities i.e. Ideology and Philosophy of the Institution, Aims and Vision, Pedagogy and Instructional Material and Teaching Learning Material and asked from the designates of the institution. After that researcher has analysed all the responses. The item wise in-depth analysis of academic activities given below in separate captions-

Ideology/Philosophy of RBS

Figure No – 2

Principles Followed by Rajghat Besant School

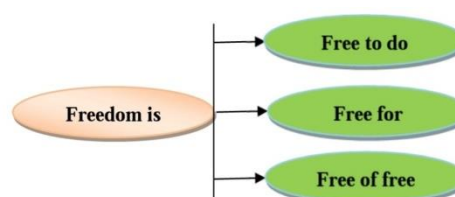


Rajghat Besant School is followed two basic principles.

Aims and Vision of RBS

Rajghat Besant School has followed the principle of 'Freedom' which is the main principle of J. Krishnamurti's philosophy. In the light of this philosophy RBS tries to give completely free environment to the students. So that the concept of education in RBS is 'Freedom' not outward political and social but 'freedom of the mind' from the known and whelm into the unknown that would be really something which is unique.

They defines the concept of 'Freedom' and refers the ideology of J. Krishnamurti's, because Krsihnamurti does not define anything as such, Krsihnamurti says what it is not and which means Krsihnamurti philosophically negates i.e. if we talk about love Krsihnamurti doesn't say about love he says what is not love. So what remains from what is not love is love. This is called philosophy of negation. Same with the freedom, generally-



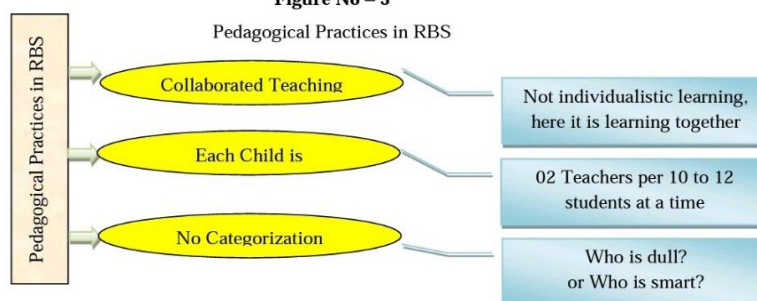
So these prepositions actually are the conditionally of this concept freedom and often wonder that this freedom is all about. It would be interesting to discover what is not freedom then surely what remains is freedom. Rajghat Besant School is continuously trying to follow above principle with the vision of reconstructing the society through the mind, which is called 'New Mind' in J. Krishnamurti's philosophy.

Pedagogy

There are several pedagogical practices found in Rajghat Besant School (RBS) shown in figure number 3

Figure No – 3

Pedagogical Practices in RBS



So that in Rajghat Besant School, each and every child is important, and the teachers do not impose anything on children. They also believe that each and every child has some own pace of learning. Therefore, in nutshell, they are trying to collaborate with the children.

Instructional Material/Teaching Learning Material

In RBS most of the teachers preferred teacher made material but they also used smart classes and audio visual aids as a tool only. RBS also have all type of modern technology. It depends on

individual teacher only as per the requirement of the subjects they taught i.e. teacher of Art subject, generally in Art subjects own hand is ultimate tool, so teacher uses minimal tools as hand is the best otherwise there is a lot of mechanization. There are tools of sculpting for preparing clay but teachers do not use that. Same as with the other subjects also.

Personality Development Activities

In RBS, personality is something which is projected through-

- Our behaviour
- Communication
- Skills
- Confidence

It is not depending on any degree or certificate attained by us but on the confidence which a person has with or without any degree or certificates. So, in this way they believe that personality development is only possible when focus should be on internal and external traits of human being. They also believe that personality development is incidental outcome. It's not the primary purpose. Personality gets developed gradually so they are more focused on projection than training. They believe that personality cannot be measured because who can judge others, when you do not have the ability to judge yourself. In support of that they give logic that every person has its own world, and this cannot be assess. They have tools for assessing learning and knowledge of students but in terms of personality assessment, they do not have any personality assessment tool. They use observation for this purpose.

Value Development Activities

Rajghat Besant School focuses on discovering values rather imposing. In RBS teachers gives few situations to the students so that they can discover and it becomes intact rather imposed values.

Generally, in RBS they are more emphasised on-

- Value of Relating- Relate with others because their relationships are very helpful to understand-
 - What you are? and
 - What other is outside?

These relationships are not in an ordinary way of relationships, it is with every day.

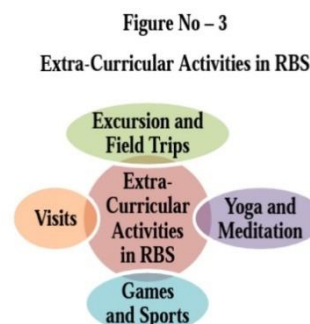
- We are whole- We are one, 'I am not separate from you'
- Honesty and Humanity

In RBS there is no specific strategy for inculcating these values in students because the way we carry ourselves for i.e. each teacher is not an example for others but he or she should try to engage himself or herself. The children who are living together or beside they also get a sense that there is something important that I need to engage with. They discover on their own.

Co-curricular Activities

Rajghat Besant School is not much appreciated co-curricular activities because many parents feel that they study less. They believe that Physical education is very important for the students. In spite of that there are various activities are organised by RBS throughout the year i.e. art, dance, music sports, adventure etc.

Extra-curricular Activities



All are activities organized for the students i.e. excursion, visits, field trips, yoga, meditation, games and sports etc. because they believe that these activities are very important in many ways basically emotionally and socially. They learn from these activities-

- People who are living in different mindset
- Having different values
- Cope up and relate with them
- How to remain isolated

School and Community Relationship

Rajghat Besant School gives emphasis on school community relation because they believe that community engagement is very important and essential for the students. So that they organize Parent-Teacher meeting for interaction with parents of the child. They have also community work programme, where children go out of the school and

worth outside. They are more focused on community work programme because-

- Students interact with the society
- They can aware social problems
- Development of mutual respect students and the society
- Developing insight for social issues

In this way Rajghat Besant School, is trying to develop social sensitivity in the students.

Conclusion

Researcher has found that 'Freedom from Fear' is most dominant philosophical component in J. Krishnamurti's philosophy. That means children should be free from any kind of fear e.g. prejudices, traditions etc. It is only possible through right kind of education in which child can transform in a good human being who is alive, fresh, and eager. J. Krishnamurti described that an 'Educated Mind' is one that is active and alive that looks, watches, listens and feels. So that he was much focused on overall development of all facets of human being.

Rajghat Besant School (RBS) is continuously trying to exercise the ideological insights of J. Krishnamurti on grass root level. RBS provides free, open and natural environment to all students. Researcher has found various school activities, plans, programmes, strategies etc. which are being organized and arranged by RBS, keeping in mind the ideological insights of Krishnamurti e.g. no discrimination; who is dull, bright or clever, collaborated teaching; learning together, individual assistance; one teacher per ten or twelve students. It reflects that RBS organized various academic and other activities for ensuring proper development of child. So that, it seems that Rajghat Besant School is trying to follow the basic principle of education 'Freedom from Fear', which is given by the Jiddu Krishnamurti in school practices. They are very focused on the development of human consciousness and they organized school activities and programmes accordingly. Thus, the Researcher has found that the ideology of J. Krishnamurti create distinctive atmosphere and regulate functions of Rajghat Besant School (RBS).

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